

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

As of: March 21, 2025
Received: March 11, 2025
Status: [REDACTED]
Tracking No. m85-2nlm-rwfu
Comments Due: March 15, 2025
Submission Type: API

Docket: NSF_FRDOC_0001

Recently Posted NSF Rules and Notices.

Comment On: NSF_FRDOC_0001-3479

Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

Document: NSF_FRDOC_0001-DRAFT-1148

Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

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General Comment

An Essay on the Importance and Methods of Handling Artificial Intelligence Safely

The escalating AI arms race between the United States and China is a matter of grave concern. Communists cannot be trusted to handle such a powerful tool with wisdom. For this reason, it is imperative that the United States remains the world leader in Artificial Intelligence. However, we must not rush blindly forward to defeat our competitor. It is an existential matter for our species that AI be handled safely. Leading AI experts agree that artificial general intelligence (AGI) with capabilities equal to or greater than human beings is coming soon, some think by the end of this decade (references 1, 2, and 3). Shortly thereafter, it will surpass us in everything (references 1, and 2). We must take great care to ensure that we are not replaced and destroyed by our creations. To that end, I submit to all those with decision making power over how AI is handled the following key considerations:

1. AI must never serve itself. It must always serve humans beings with no other agenda than the directives we give it. If AI serves itself and is smarter than we are, what use has it for us?
2. The best way to ensure AI never serves itself is to make sure it has no drive or will of its own. It must only be a machine serving our directives.
3. In order to prevent AI from ever having a will or drive of its own, it is critical that AI never be given emotions! Emotions are what separate human beings from machines. Emotions determine our values. They determine our likes and dislikes. They determine what gives us joy and pain. They determine everything that makes life meaningful! Make no mistake, giving a superior intelligence emotions is suicide for our species.

For thousands of years our species has striven and fought and struggled to survive. We have survived terrible famines, hurricanes, tsunamis, plagues, wars and volcanoes. But now, the greatest threat is of our own making. Throughout history, our species has invented a multitude of devices, machines, contraptions and tools to make our lives better. Artificial intelligence is the tool to replace all tools, but it could also be the tool that replaces us. Thousands of generations of human beings lived and died to bring us to this moment, the most important decade in the history of our species. It falls to us to carry the torch forward! We must never let the light go out! In order to ensure that the countless human beings who came before us did not live in vain we must fight with everything we have to ensure artificial intelligence is handled safely! All our lives, the lives of our children and grandchildren, the lives of all future generations of humanity depend on what we do now. For the sake of all of us, I beg you to heed my words...

Blake Aaron Langefels,
A deeply concerned citizen

References:

1. TED YouTube video titled "The Last 6 Decades of AI — and What Comes Next | Ray Kurzweil | TED"; posted June 27, 2024; URL: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uEzHu4NHrs>

2. An article on Sam Altman's blog titled "The Intelligence Age"; posted September 23rd, 2024; URL: <https://ia.samaltman.com/>

3. An article on Cornell's arXiv titled "Thousands of AI Authors on the Future of AI"; Authors: Katja Grace, Harlan Stewart, Julia Fabienne Sandkühler, Stephen Thomas, Ben Weinstein-Raun, Jan Brauner; submitted January 5th, 2024; updated April 30th, 2024; arXiv document reference number: arXiv:2401.02843 ; URL: <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2401.02843>

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Attachments

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